

Chapter 122-4

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Liang Shi felt she needed to get drunk.

The impact of what she encountered during the day was too great. But the two of them first went to the hospital to see Gu Xingyue.

However, because Gu Xingyue was involved in a malicious murder case, she had become a key protected person by both the Public Security Bureau and the hospital to prevent anyone from causing her secondary harm.

The two went to the hospital only to return empty-handed.

Other than passively waiting for results, there was nothing they could do.

On the way leaving the hospital, Chen Mian said, "She really surprised me."

Liang Shi nodded, "I didn't expect her to be this ruthless."

"If Qi Jiao also had..." Chen Mian paused mid-sentence and rejected her own statement, "No, there are no ifs."

Qi Jiao was Qi Jiao.

She could never do something like this.

Because those were her biological parents.

But for Gu Xingyue, it was different—they were just two demons.

People who had nothing to do with her.

Gu Xingyue resisting Yang Jiani was like a prisoner resisting a warden, without any bonds of familial affection or blood.

She might even feel a faint sense of pleasure after getting her revenge. But for Qi Jiao, it wouldn't be like that.

If Qi Jiao had done this, for the rest of her life, she would frequently dream about it.

She would forever live in self-blame and guilt.

It was hard to say which was better, but in the end, the one who would suffer would always be Qi Jiao.

When the conversation turned to Qi Jiao, the atmosphere suddenly became heavy.

For a moment, neither of them spoke.

Liang Shi sat in Chen Mian's passenger seat. Her brain, which had been busy all day, finally stole a moment of peace. She took out her phone and sent a message to Xu Qingzhu: [Are you home?]

Xu Qingzhu replied instantly: [Mm.]

Liang Shi told her: [The crew has suspended filming.]

Xu Qingzhu: [Because of Shu Yi?]

Liang Shi: [Yes.]

Shu Yi's incident had been on the trending list for two days, so Xu Qingzhu naturally knew about it.

But she hadn't known what the "Mo Guang" crew was planning to do about it. Liang Shi had still been waiting at the hotel for the outcome last night.

Now the outcome was out, and it was evening again.

Xu Qingzhu sent a voice message: "Are you coming home tonight then?"

Liang Shi replied: [I am, but I'm going to drink first.]

Xu Qingzhu: [.....]

Before she could ask, Liang Shi added: [With Chen Mian. She said she wants to treat me to drinks.]

Xu Qingzhu: [.....]

Liang Shi: [I'll try to stay sober when I come home. Go to bed early.]

Xu Qingzhu: [.....]

Three ellipses in a row—even someone as oblivious as Liang Shi understood that Xu Qingzhu had something she wanted to say.

Liang Shi asked: [What's wrong?]

Xu Qingzhu didn't reply for a long time.

Liang Shi vaguely felt that Xu Qingzhu was angry, but she really didn't want to go home after experiencing such huge emotional turmoil, afraid of bringing her bad mood to Xu Qingzhu.

Even though Xu Qingzhu had said: Liang Shi, you can be yourself.

But that didn't mean she should make Xu Qingzhu bear her bad emotions.

She just needed to get drunk, sleep it off, and calm her feelings.

She hoped Xu Qingzhu would be happy every day.

Liang Shi sent another message to Xu Qingzhu: [Don't go silent on me.]

Xu Qingzhu still didn't reply.

Liang Shi glanced at Chen Mian in the car. Chen Mian was turning the steering wheel to make a turn, her lips pressed tightly together, looking unapproachable.

Liang Shi's lips parted slightly, and Chen Mian said, "Want to go home?"

Liang Shi: "....."

For a moment, she didn't know whether to say yes or no.

She had already agreed to go with Chen Mian. Wouldn't it be bad to back out now?

But not going home after the crew suspended filming and instead going out drinking with Chen Mian—that seemed like something that would make Xu Qingzhu angry.

Now Xu Qingzhu wasn't even replying to messages.

If she had taken the initiative and seized control of the conversation earlier, she wouldn't be in such a difficult position now.¹

She stared at Chen Mian for a few seconds. That "mm" she was about to say suddenly changed direction and became "How could that be?"

Chen Mian said, "I thought as soon as your girlfriend urged you, you'd want to go home."

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi lowered her head and sent another message to Xu Qingzhu: [Don't be angry. I won't get drunk.]

Her coaxing was exceptionally stiff.

But this was already the result of what Liang Shi had learned.

Footnotes:

¹ **Difficult position (騎虎難下):** A Chinese idiom literally meaning "riding a tiger and finding it hard to dismount." It describes being in a situation where it's difficult to either continue or stop—being stuck in an awkward predicament of one's own making.